

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: What is the future of old age?



Learning Outcome

Describe unusual events through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- If you could live to the age of 500, what would you do with all that time?
- What age do you think your great-great-great grandchildren will live to?

Can Do Statements

- I can say and use words like *fine*.
- I can say and use words like *different* and *interesting*.
- I can use proper intonation when I'm sure and when I'm checking.





Let's Explore!

What is the **fountain of youth***? Is it possible to stay young forever?

* The "*fountain of youth*" is water that restores the youth of anyone who drinks or bathes in it.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

What is the future of old age? To answer that question and to shine a light on the issue, we need to re-examine our conventional notion of how we live, how we age, and when we die. In the last hundred years, life expectancy has increased. In fact, it has doubled. People live to a more advanced age because of better nutrition (more vegetables, less chocolate - or at least the right kind of chocolate, a glass of wine a day), healthier lifestyles, and incredible advances in healthcare and medical science.

Philosophers, doctors, and scientists have been striving for that fountain of youth since the beginning of recorded history. We all want to live forever, right? We all want to reach our diamond wedding anniversary, don't we? For some in the medical community, their lofty, but interesting aim is to reformulate the current concept of human life. Their research focuses on extending the deadline of the human lifespan, extending our lives by decades, centuries or more. However, there are many people who have questions about whether immortality should even be considered - that it should remain up to the divine powers.

The newest and most ambitious ideas are about integrating humans and technology to create beings that can live for thousands of years. We've all seen *The Terminator*, haven't we? This is the most dangerous of all pursuits, isn't it?





Let's Practice!

Do you want to live a very long life? Let's see what Sally wrote in her blog!

Instructions: Draw a line to match the sentences in Column A and Column B.

COLUMN A

1. To live different and longer lives,
2. It's interesting to see
3. It's dangerous to try
4. Getting to your diamond wedding anniversary
5. Chocolate can be good

COLUMN B

- a. to make humans live for hundreds of years.
- b. how life expectancy changes.
- c. people are eating more vegetables and less chocolate.
- d. requires a really healthy lifestyle.
- e. if not consumed in excess.



Let's Practice!

Sally uses different intonation when she wants to confirm ideas or when she's sure about things.

Instructions: Choose the words from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences.

Word Bank

hasn't it / don't we / isn't it / haven't we / right

1. Life expectancy has increased in recent years, _____?
2. We all want to live forever, _____?
3. We all want to reach our diamond wedding anniversary, _____?
4. We've all seen Terminator, _____?
5. This is the most dangerous of all pursuits, _____?





Extension Activity

Watch the movie *The Terminator*.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Find the movie *The Terminator* online or at your video store.
- As you watch the movie, think about the idea of integrating technology and humans.
- With a partner, discuss the movie and the implications it has for the future of old age.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I watch the movie *The Terminator*.

☐ ☐

I consider the idea of integrating technology and humans.

☐ ☐

I discuss the movie with a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **conventional** (adjective): traditional; related to tradition
e.g. We need to re-examine our conventional notion of how we live, how we age, and when we die.
- **notion** (noun): idea; point of view
e.g. We need to re-examine our conventional notion of how we live, how we age, and when we die.
- **life expectancy** (noun): the projected duration of a person's life
e.g. In the last hundred years, life expectancy has increased.
- **philosopher** (noun): a person who studies topics related to ethics or metaphysics
e.g. Philosophers have looked for a fountain of youth.
- **diamond wedding anniversary** (noun): a celebration of the 60th year of marriage
e.g. We all want to reach our diamond wedding anniversary.
- **lofty** (adjective): very high; eminent
e.g. Their lofty but interesting goal is to redefine the nature of human life.
- **immortality** (noun): the condition of perpetual life
e.g. However, there are many people who have questions about whether immortality should even be considered.
- **pursuit** (noun): the act of looking for something, especially a goal
e.g. Integrating humans and technology to create immortals is a dangerous pursuit.



Learning Points

Silent Syllables in Which Unstressed Vowels are not Pronounced

Syllables are the sound groupings in words.

For example:

Ca - na - da

Com - pu - ter

Usually, you pronounce each syllable in a word.

Some words in English have syllables which are not pronounced.

Some examples are:

vegetable -----> veg**table

chocolate -----> choc**late

diamond -----> di**mond

interesting ----> int**resting

dangerous -----> dang**rous

Practice saying the words above. Clap each time you say a syllable.

Examples:

- *People are living longer because of better nutrition (more vegetables, less chocolate - or at least the right kind of chocolate, a glass of red wine a day).*
- *For some in the medical community, their lofty, but interesting goal is to redefine the very nature of human life.*
- *This is the most dangerous of all pursuits, isn't it?*





Learning Points

Words That End in *-ine*

In English, many words share similar endings. One common ending is *-ine*.

Generally, when a word ends with the vowel **e**, the vowel that comes before it is pronounced with its long sound. You can see this rule when you read and say words that end in *-ine*.

For example:

f - **i** - n - **e** ----> the word is pronounced with the long vowel sound for the letter **i** (as in the word *eye*)

You can use this rule with other words and for other sounds.

For example:

g - **a** - m - **e** ----> the word is pronounced with the long vowel sound for the letter **a** (as in the word *day*)

b - **o** - n - **e** ----> the word is pronounced with the long vowel sound for the letter **o** (as in the word *go*)

Here are some examples of words that end in *-ine*.

fine

dine

wine

line

redefine

shine

deadline

divine

Practice reading these sentences aloud. Focus on the pronunciation of the *-ine* sound.

- *It should remain up to the **divine** powers.*
- *Their lofty, but interesting goal is to **redefine** the very nature of human life.*
- *To answer that question and to shine a light on the issue, we need to reconsider our conventional notion of life.*
- *A glass of red **wine** a day ...*

